RSS Digest
Generated at: 2026-10-24 13:29:23

1. Ubiquiti’s $99 Vape Detector is actually pretty good
Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 09:00:00 -0400
Link: https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/ubiquiti-vape-detector-teardown/
Since learning about the effects of high CO2 concentration on attention and cognitive performance?especially at levels much higher than 2000ppm?I’ve started monitoring CO2 and other air quality indicators in my house, at my studio, and even on the road. I have a few other air quality monitors I’ll be covering in the future, but today I wanted to focus on one I only heard about in the comments on a recent video tearing down a cheap no-name ’Air Quality Detector’ from Amazon .

2. Quick Study
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-23T21:35:13+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/23/quick-study-painter/
Tool: Quick Study Prompt to Claude Opus 5.5 High : Build an artifact where you open a photo and it rapidly (in a few seconds) paints a version of that photo using a canvas element and simulated paintbrush See also my previous experiment getting Claude Fable to simulate a watercolor illustration with P5.js. Quick Study uses Sobel edge detection , with no external libraries beyond Google Fonts. Tags: tools

3. Introducing Kimi K3.1 Pro
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-23T19:40:54+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/23/kimi-k31-pro/
Introducing Kimi K3.1 Pro Kimi K3.1 Pro landed on the Kimi API today - it’s not yet open weights, but Moonshot promise "Full model weights will be released by Nov 4, 2026". They’re also offering a "Highspeed" version that’s 2-3x faster, at twice the price (except for input token cache hits, which are priced the same). The US dollar pricing is $2.00/million tokens for input and $10/million for output - the same as GPT-6.1 Sol and half the price of Claude Opus 5.5. Moonshot’s own benchmarks show Kimi as approximately level with Opus 5.5 and GPT-6 Astra - beating them on a few benchmarks, coming close on others. Artificial Analysis scored Kimi at 55 - ahead of Claude Fable 5.1, GPT-6 Astra, and Gemini 4 Argon (all at 53) and behind only Claude Opus 5.5 (58). This is the first time a (soon-to-be) open weight model has scored this highly against the frontier. I tried it out via the Moonshot API using the llm openai endpoint command I added to LLM 0.32 back in August: llm openai endpoint \ https://api.moonshot.ai/v1 \ --key kimi \ -m kimi-k3.1-pro \ "Generate an SVG of a pelican riding a bicycle" \ --responses \ -o reasoning_effort low \ > kimi-k3.1-pro-pelican-low.stdout.txt \ 2> kimi-...

4. Why didn?t we use the COM static store to clean up the unmarshalable delegate?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261023-00/?p=112793/
It cleans up at the wrong time. The post Why didn?t we use the COM static store to clean up the unmarshalable delegate? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

5. Why didn?t we use Co›Register›Initialize›Spy to clean up the unmarshalable delegate?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 22 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261022-00/?p=112791/
Looking more closely at the function’s behavior and requirements. The post Why didn?t we use Co›Register›Initialize›Spy to clean up the unmarshalable delegate? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. The Verge?s Duo Review: ?Apple?s Folding Phone Is a Messy, Expensive Good Time?
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-23T16:52:56Z
Link: https://www.theverge.com/tech/1015028/iphone-duo-review

Nilay Patel and Allison Johnson (also: 26-minute video review on YouTube): This means almost every time you open the phone you instinctively rotate it, and while it will work no matter how it?s rotated, it?s better to rotate it counterclockwise so the cameras are on top and the volume buttons are on the top left. Over our week of testing, this started feeling more natural, but it?s exactly the opposite of what you?d initially expect. It?s especially odd in Apple?s bumper case, which has a large notch to expose the Touch ID sensor and camera control, and it looks for all the world like it belongs at the bottom. You might think this is a little thing, but it?s strange to find yourself slightly unsure of how to hold a smartphone. A nontrivial part of the Duo experience is just reorienting yourself to where the volume buttons are as you flip the thing around. When closed, they?re on top of the phone, but if you rotate the Duo clockwise, they end up on the bottom right, and it?s the top button that turns the volume down because they don?t change orientation with the display. There?s a buried setting in iOS that makes the volume buttons reorient themselves as you turn the Duo around; A...

7. Joanna Stern Reviews the Duo: ?The Good, the Bad, and the Buggy?
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-23T14:42:06Z
Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bxDTWuL9GxY
Joanna Stern?s video review packs a ton into 16 minutes. She commissioned a custom robot to fold/unfold the thing over 32,000 times in a week, to see if it loosened the hinge. (I won?t spoil the answer.) She took it on a yacht on the Hudson. She took it to a dark bar to test the cameras. And she really, really missed Face ID. I don?t know how she makes these videos in just a week, along with all the actual testing. So good. We rank our complaints (and praise) in different order, but overall her take jibes with mine on every single point. You can read a version of her review , too, if you?re a subscriber to The New Things, which you should be. ?

8. Gurman on HomeView: ?Finished Units Have Been Sitting Boxed Up in Warehouses for the Better Part of a Year?
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-18T21:58:33Z
Link: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/newsletters/2026-10-18/apple-homeview-with-robotic-arm-new-mac-ipad-mini-nov-6-release-iphone-duo?accessToken=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJzb3VyY2UiOiJTdWJzY3JpYmVyR2lmdGVkQXJ0aWNsZSIsImlhdCI6MTc5MjMzMjQwNiwiZXhwIjoxNzkyOTM3MjA2LCJhcnRpY2xlSWQiOiJUTjNXODFLR1pBSjQwMCIsImJjb25uZWN0SWQiOiJDNEVEQ0FFMUZBMDU0MEJFQTI0QTlGMjExQzFFOTA4M.eu94lgz5qU35YdXhWFRwjbVBeJEKzpwFqF-pzh_GPJU&leadSource=article-gifting
Mark Gurman, today, in his weekly Power On column for Bloomberg (gift link): Without a serviceable version of the new assistant, Apple couldn?t deliver the experience it had envisioned. That left the hardware ready to go, but the software nowhere near finished. So Apple postponed the HomeView repeatedly ? first until spring 2025, then summer, then fall, and then again throughout 2026 before finally unveiling it this past week. And the hardware betrays its age. With thick bezels, an A18 processor and 8 gigabytes of memory, this is clearly a product conceived years ago. Finished units have been sitting boxed up in warehouses for the better part of a year, waiting for the software to catch up. The A18 chip and 8 GB of RAM aren?t a sure sign of delay; this year?s MacBook Neo has the 18 Pro chip and only 8 GB RAM , and wasn?t delayed. And if a kick-ass MacBook can get by with an A18-class chip and 8 GB RAM, surely a HomeView can too. HomeView only does a fraction of what a Mac can do, and the MacBook Neo is perhaps Apple?s best new product in years, full stop. But I have no reason to doubt Gurman that this hardware was finished and production started long ago. His reporting on this pro...

9. "No way to prevent this" say users of only language where this regularly happens
Source: Xe Iaso’s blog | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://xeiaso.net/shitposts/no-way-to-prevent-this/memory-safety/CVE-2026-89078/
A forlorn businessman resting his head against a wall beside a window. Photo by Andrea Piacquadio, via Pexels. In the hours following the release of CVE-2026-89078 for the project Ruby , site reliability workers and systems administrators scrambled to desperately rebuild and patch all their systems to fix a double free in Ruby’s Onigmo regular expression parser when

parsing fails after an alternation, allowing memory corruption and potential remote code execution in applications that compile attacker-controlled patterns. This is due to the affected components being written in C, the only programming language where these vulnerabilities regularly happen. "This was a terrible tragedy, but sometimes these things just happen and there’s nothing anyone can do to stop them," said programmer Miss Ebony Reilly, echoing statements expressed by hundreds of thousands of programmers who use the only language where 90% of the world’s memory safety vulnerabilities have occurred in the last 50 years, and whose projects are 20 times more likely to have security vulnerabilities. "It’s a shame, but what can we do? There really isn’t anything we can do to prevent memory safety vulnerabilities from h...

10. More phishing messages via Booking.com and Novotel
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 11:34:15 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/more-phishing-messages-via-booking-com-and-novotel/
A few days ago I booked a Novotel hotel on Booking.com - two days later I received these phishing messages via WhatsApp. Both knew my exact name, phone number, location of stay, and date of stay. Luckily, both were fairly inept. Let’s take a quick look at them. The first came from a Portuguese business account. Obviously the name doesn’t match that of the large chain hotel I booked with. The ?

11. One Small Bug
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-23T09:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/23/one-small-bug.html
> add a CSV export button to the invoices page, same columns as the table ? Clauding? Done. The button is in InvoiceTable.tsx and the endpoint is GET /invoices.csv , using the same column definitions as the table. Tests pass. While I was in there I noticed paginate() in lib/pagination.ts drops the last row when the total is an exact multiple of the page size. Want me to fix that too? > y ? Fuddling? Fixed, with a test for the boundary case. While the tests were running, pnpm install resolved a transitive dependency that had been published 77 minutes earlier. Your .npmrc sets minimum-release-age , but the pnpm version pinned in packageManager predates that setting and silently ignores unknown keys. The Nx Console postmortem describes the same configuration. In the other lockfiles, uv.lock includes vulpine-lz4 as a dependency of snekpack . It was the subject of CVE-2024-YIKES and CVE-2026-LGTM . Want me to upgrade pnpm and remove snekpack ? > y ? Lockfiling? pnpm is on 12.12.1 and snekpack is gone. The newer pnpm also stops reading registry settings for its own bootstrap from the repository?s .npmrc , where yours sets them. I left Dependabot?s cooldown in place, though a dependabot-...

12. RMSNorm
Source: Giles’ blog | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 18:40:00 +0000
Link: https://www.gilesthomas.com/2026/10/rmsnorm
Normalisation is an essential part of LLMs. In the GPT-2 code, we use LayerNorm in a bunch of different places -- in each Transformer block, we do it just before we feed our incoming context vectors into the multi-head attention module, and then again before we feed the result through the FFN: ...and we also do one more round just before we project our context vectors into vocab space via the output head. We do that to make the model more trainable; it helps to prevent vanishing or exploding gradients, by constraining the vectors going into our attention, feed-forward and output head modules so that they have a reasonably stable set of statistical properties. And when (as part of my black-box reimplementation of GPT-2 in JAX) I tried training an almost-complete model without LayerNorm, training completely failed after about 100 steps -- the loss went up to the kind of level that I’d expect from an uninitialised model, and stayed there despite another 700 or so training steps. (Later on in this post I’ll show results from a similar run.) So, normalisation is important. But it doesn’t have to be LayerNorm specifically -- if you look at the currently-popular open models, a lot of t...

13. Premium: The Hater’s Guide To Blackstone

Source: Ed Zitron’s Where’s Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 16:28:34 GMT
Link: https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-the-haters-guide-to-blackstone/
For whatever reason, Blackstone founder and CEO Stephen A. Schwarzman has a thirty-chapter-long series called ? My Personal History ? that is, well, exactly what it sounds like ? a financial hagiography that frames him as a noble, sensible man with strong values, like when he sent a

14. Pluralistic: Critique and writing (23 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 20:44:02 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/23/better-to-give/
Today’s links Critique and writing: The most important part of a writing workshop is trying to fix other people’s stories. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: USPS nukes the mail; Enron Explorer; "Scored"; UAE’s international hacker legion; NZ provides hacking tools to torturers; Truecrypt insecure; The Traitorous Eight. Upcoming appearances: Vancouver, Ottawa, Vienna, Kilkenny, Courtenay, Vancouver, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest.
Critique and writing (permalink) Through my own writing life, nothing has done more to improve my writing than diligent participation in peer-based workshops; that’s where a group of writers, all at about the same stage in their artistic development, gather to read one another’s work and offer feedback specifically aimed at improving each other’s stories. This is a deceptively simple exercise, and the reasons it works so well are quite counter-intuitive.
The most obvious benefit is the way that a workshop encourages you to write at all. When you’re...

15. An Ion Storm!, Part 2: The Return to Ground Level
Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 23 Oct 2026 16:19:26 +0000
Link: https://www.filfre.net/2026/10/an-ion-storm-part-2-the-return-to-ground-level/
This article tells part of the story of John Romero. Note that there is a sexually suggestive image below that may be Not Safe For Work! In the badlands of what used to be Texas, rumor has it that John Romero has thrown himself out the window of Ion Storm?s penthouse offices. Apparently Romero had [?]